

QuickLogic joins CHIPS Alliance to enhance open source FPGA efforts

QuickLogic Corporation, a developer of ultra-low power multi-core voice-enabled SoCs, embedded FPGA IP, and endpoint AI solutions has joined the CHIPS Alliance. This alliance is a consortium for advancing common and open hardware for interfaces, processors and systems.

Brian Faith, president and CEO at QuickLogic, said, “Over the past few years, the electronics industry has seen a big shift towards open source hardware and software, and we are proud to be one of the companies at the forefront of that movement. We have already been working closely with several CHIPS Alliance members to make FPGA tools and devices more accessible, and we look forward to continuing these efforts as an official member of the organisation.”

QuickLogic recently announced the QuickLogic Open Reconfigurable Computing (QORC) initiative, which aims to broaden access to open FPGA technology for embedded systems developers. QuickLogic’s initial open source development tools, developed in collaboration with CHIPS Alliance members Google and Antmicro, consist of complete support for QuickLogic’s EOS S3 low power voice and sensor processing MCU with an integrated embedded FPGA (eFPGA), and its PolarPro 3E FPGA family.

Dr Zvonimir Bandić, chairman of the CHIPS Alliance, said, “The CHIPS Alliance is continuing to focus on expanding its member base with organisations from a diverse set of industries. QuickLogic, a leader in open source eFPGA IP and FPGA tooling, will help us drive innovation in the FPGA sector and further our mission to remove barriers for open hardware design.”

Earthquakes often have the most severe consequences in developing countries. Nearly three billion people globally live with the threat of an earthquake and don’t have access to nationwide systems. These can cost upwards of US\$ 1 billion. OpenEEW wants to help reduce the costs of EEW systems and accelerate their deployments globally.

The OpenEEW project includes several core IoT components like sensor hardware and firmware that can rapidly detect and transmit ground motion. It comprises real-time detection systems that can be deployed on various platforms, ranging from a Kubernetes cluster to a Raspberry Pi.

Grafana Labs raises US\$ 50 million and announces Grafana Accelerator Program

Grafana Labs has raised US\$ 50 million in a Series B funding round. The fund will be used to aggressively accelerate its product roadmap in key areas across its open and composable observability platform. This will allow customers to mix and match best-of-breed open and proprietary data sources, and nurture and invest in the wider Grafana community, said the company.



The funding round was led by Lightspeed Venture Partners. The oversubscribed round also included additional investment from Lead Edge Capital. Both are existing investors that participated in the company’s first institutional financing in October 2019.

Raj Dutt, co-founder and CEO of Grafana Labs, said, “Grafana Labs’ growth is a testament to one of our core missions of helping people unify and understand their data wherever it lives, giving them complete freedom in choosing their own observability strategy. This allows users to query data natively at its source in real-time, rather than having to move, store and pay for data in yet another database. Their existing data can be combined with Prometheus metrics and Loki logs, and be available on Grafana Cloud, giving them a truly complete understanding of their complex systems.”

Grafana Labs has also announced the Grafana Accelerator Program (GAP) to nurture early stage companies and side projects that are innovating in the wider Grafana ecosystem. GAP will provide free Grafana Cloud and Grafana Enterprise subscriptions, cash grants, equity financing, and inside access to the core Grafana Labs developers.

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